

MLCC materials: Benefiting from multilayering

EQUITY: JAPAN CHEMICALS & TEXTILES

Companies including Toyobo and Lintec likely to benefit

We forecast a CAGR of around 10% for demand through 2028 (over 2025 baseline)

With the multilayering of MLCCs, material manufacturers should benefit from increased volumes

Release films for MLCCs are materials used in the production of internal electrodes for MLCCs (Figure 1). We expect demand for release films to grow at an annual average rate of around 10% from 2025 to 2028 owing partly to increased demand for multilayer MLCCs for AI servers. We think higher volumes should benefit companies that sell release films, such as Toyobo [3101] (Neutral), Lintec [7966] (Buy), and Toray Industries [3402] (Neutral). A drop in selling prices in 2026 is a risk, but with only moderate capacity increases, it does not look as if capacity utilization rates will fall sharply, so we are not expecting prices to fall.

Japanese manufacturers dominate the release film market

Release films consist of a release coating layer and a base film layer. Lintec specializes in the coating layer, and Toray Industries focuses on the base film layer (Figure 2). Toyobo sells not only release films but also base film layers. Japanese companies hold over 80% of the market share for release films, and Lintec has the top share (Figure 4). We estimate that Toray Industries holds the top market share for external sales of base films.

Toyobo's new plant should start contributing in earnest from Jul–Sep 2026

Toyobo is expanding release film capacity at its Utsunomiya plant, and its new line should be fully up-and-running from Jul–Sep 2026. It has both base film and coating operations (though it mainly sells coated products not base films). We think it may be able to increase its market share from around 2027, as it is increasing capacity by more than rivals.

Lintec is likely to add capacity

Lintec has the top share of the market for release films and is relatively strong in products for high-end applications such as AI servers. The company buys base film, applies coating, and then delivers the final product to its customers. We see potential for higher sales growth than at rivals owing to increasing demand for high-end applications, the company's area of strength, in 2026. That said, Lintec has not yet decided to increase production capacity, unlike rival Toyobo, which is adding capacity in 2026. We see the possibility that Lintec will reach full capacity in 2027. With rivals expanding production capacity, it will be difficult to hike prices, and we think the company will therefore need to increase its production capacity rapidly in order to maintain its market share.

Toray Industries: Estimated global market share of over 50% for base films for MLCC release films

For MLCC release films, Toray Industries is mainly involved in base films. Its strength lies in its ability to produce extremely smooth films by leveraging technology cultivated through many years of film development, and it holds a high global market share for base films for MLCC release films (which we estimate at over 50%). The company has four production sites in three countries (the Mishima and Gifu plants in Japan, and plants in Malaysia and South Korea). Overall production capacity has increased 1.6-fold since Oct–Dec 2025 thanks to capacity increases at the Gifu plant. Sales have been strong recently too, and we forecast y-y sales volume growth of 20% in 27/3, with growth likely to continue in 28/3 and beyond in line with increased demand for MLCC films.

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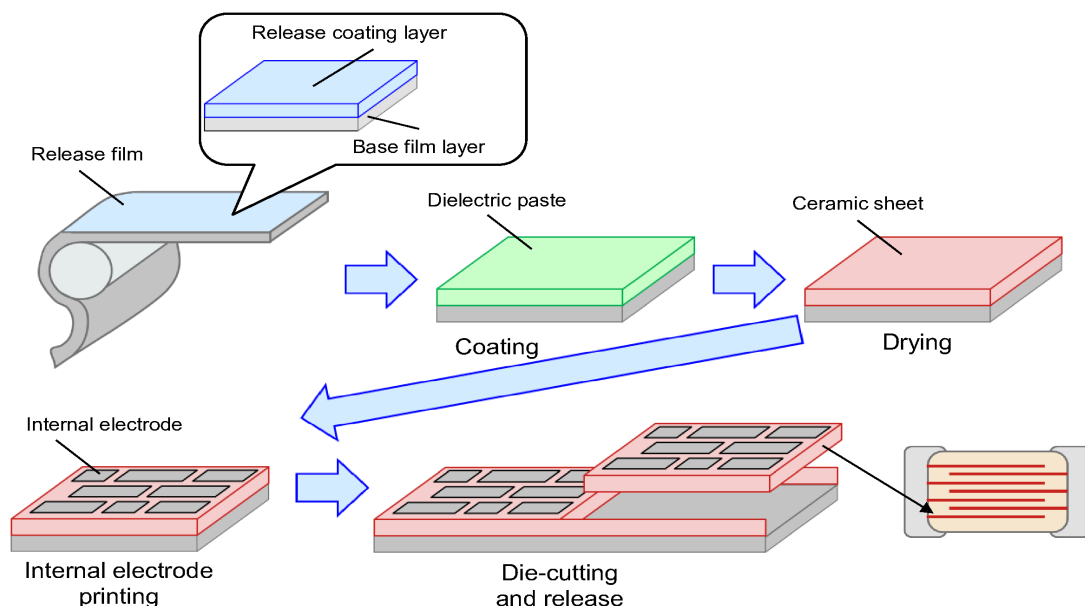
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Mitsui Chemicals: For MLCCs, is involved in base films for release films and liquid filtration products for cleaning processes

Mitsui Chemicals [4183] (Neutral) handles both base films for release films and liquid filtration products for MLCC cleaning processes. We think the contribution to overall sales and core operating profits is limited, but we expect growth along with Ixos semiconductor tape in the ICT segment.

Fig. 1: MLCC production process

Release films are used in the production of internal electrodes



Note: A release film consists of a base film layer and a release coating layer

Source: Nomura

Fig. 2: MLCC release film supply chain



Source: Nomura

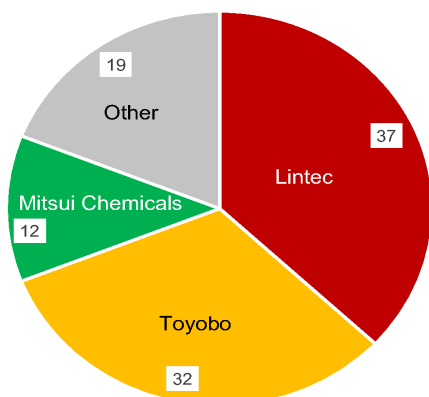
Fig. 3: Sales weightings, operating profit weightings, and operating margins at MLCC release film-related companies

(%)	As % of sales	Operating profit weighting	Operating Margin
Lintec	7	17	18
Toyobo	6	13	16
Toray Industries	1	3	15
Mitsui Chemicals	0	1	13

Note: FY25 data.

Source: Nomura estimates

Fig. 4: MLCC release film market shares



Note: (1) 2025 data. (2) Market shares are based on end products with coating; base film sales are not included.

Source: Nomura estimates

Fig. 5: Valuation table for MLCC-related companies

Code	Company	Rating	Target price	Share price 1 Jul	Market cap	PER			EV/EBITDA			Ope profit growth			PBR	ROE		
						26E	27E	28E	26E	27E	28E	26E	27E	28E		26E	27E	28E
			(¥)	(¥)	(USD mn.)	¥ bn	x		x			%			x	%		
3101 JP	Toyobo	Neutral	1,800.0	1,600.0	875.9	142.5	13.7	12.4	11.8	7.0	6.6	6.2	5.4	8.2	4.4	0.6	4.8	5.1
3402 JP	Toray Industries	Neutral	1,170.0	1,125.0	10,405.4	1,692.5	18.6	17.0	15.4	7.8	7.2	6.7	50.0	7.4	8.7	0.8	4.7	4.8
4183 JP	Mitsui Chemicals	Neutral	2,140.0	2,126.5	5,251.4	854.2	16.7	10.9	9.9	6.7	5.5	5.2	23.3	40.2	12.3	0.9	5.3	7.9
7966 JP	Lintec	Buy	7,850.0	7,110.0	3,168.5	515.4	17.8	15.5	14.5	8.6	7.3	6.7	22.0	35.2	7.5	1.7	8.3	10.6
6976 JP	Taiyo Yuden	Neutral	5,900.0	22,655.0	18,150.0	2,952.3	87.4	66.3	58.2	31.0	26.6	24.4	125.0	31.1	13.6	7.7	9.1	11.2
6981 JP	Murata Manufacturing	Buy	6,000.0	11,890.0	143,490.1	23,340.1	65.6	47.1	42.6	35.3	26.9	24.3	48.3	41.6	11.0	7.4	11.7	14.9
6762 JP	TDK	Buy	3,500.0	3,700.0	44,216.7	7,192.3	29.8	25.0	22.2	12.5	10.7	9.4	13.8	18.7	12.8	2.9	10.2	11.0
Russell/Nomura Large Cap (ex financials)							20.7	18.4	17.0	11.8	10.8	10.2	24.9	13.1	8.1	2.0	10.1	10.7

Note: Lintec's P/E is shown on an adjusted basis.

Source: Nomura

Appendix A-1

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Transactions involving convertible bonds are subject to a sales commission of up to 1.10% (tax included) of the transaction amount (or a commission of ¥4,400 (tax included) if this would be less than ¥4,400). When convertible bonds are purchased via OTC transactions (including offerings), only the purchase price shall be paid, with no sales commission charged. However, Nomura Securities may charge a separate fee for OTC transactions, as agreed with the customer. Convertible bonds carry the risk of losses owing to factors such as interest rate fluctuations and price fluctuations in the underlying stock. In addition, convertible bonds denominated in foreign currencies also carry the risk of losses owing to factors such as foreign exchange rate fluctuations.

When bonds are purchased via public offerings, secondary distributions, or other OTC transactions with Nomura Securities, only the purchase price shall be paid, with no sales commission charged. Bonds carry the risk of losses, as prices fluctuate in line with changes in market interest rates. Bond prices may also fall below the invested principal as a result of such factors as changes in the management and financial circumstances of the issuer, or changes in third-party valuations of the bond in question. In addition, foreign currency-denominated bonds also carry the risk of losses owing to factors such as foreign exchange rate fluctuations.

When Japanese government bonds (JGBs) for individual investors are purchased via public offerings, only the purchase price shall be paid, with no sales commission charged. As a rule, JGBs for individual investors may not be sold in the first 12 months after issuance. When JGBs for individual investors are sold before maturity, an amount calculated via the following formula will be subtracted from the par value of the bond plus accrued interest: (1) for 10-year variable rate bonds, an amount equal to the two preceding coupon payments (before tax) x 0.79685 will be used, (2) for 5-year and 3-year fixed rate bonds, an amount equal to the two preceding coupon payments (before tax) x 0.79685 will be used.

When inflation-indexed JGBs are purchased via public offerings, secondary distributions (uridashi deals), or other OTC transactions with Nomura Securities, only the purchase price shall be paid, with no sales commission charged. Inflation-indexed JGBs carry the risk of losses, as prices fluctuate in line with changes in market interest rates and fluctuations in the nationwide consumer price index. The notional principal of inflation-indexed JGBs changes in line with the rate of change in nationwide CPI inflation from the time of its issuance. The amount of the coupon payment is calculated by multiplying the coupon rate by the notional principal at the time of payment. The maturity value is the amount of the notional principal when the issue becomes due. For J117 and subsequent issues, the maturity value shall not undercut the face amount. Purchases of investment trusts (and sales of some investment trusts) are subject to a purchase or sales fee of up to 5.5% (tax included) of the transaction amount. Also, a direct cost that may be incurred when selling investment trusts is a fee of up to 2.0% of the unit price at the time of redemption. Indirect costs that may be incurred during the course of holding investment trusts include, for domestic investment trusts, an asset

management fee (trust fee) of up to 5.5% (tax included/annualized basis) of the net assets in trust, as well as fees based on investment performance. Other indirect costs may also be incurred. For foreign investment trusts, indirect fees may be incurred during the course of holding such as investment company compensation.

Investment trusts invest mainly in securities such as Japanese and foreign equities and bonds, whose prices fluctuate. Investment trust unit prices fluctuate owing to price fluctuations in the underlying assets and to foreign exchange rate fluctuations. As such, investment trusts carry the risk of losses. Fees and risks vary by investment trust. Maximum applicable fees are subject to change; please thoroughly read the written materials provided, such as prospectuses or documents delivered before making a contract.

In interest rate swap transactions and USD/JPY basis swap transactions ("interest rate swap transactions, etc."), only the agreed transaction payments shall be made on the settlement dates. Some interest rate swap transactions, etc. may require pledging of margin collateral. In some of these cases, transaction payments may exceed the amount of collateral. There shall be no advance notification of required collateral value or collateral ratios as they vary depending on the transaction. Interest rate swap transactions, etc. carry the risk of losses owing to fluctuations in market prices in the interest rate, currency and other markets, as well as reference indices. Losses incurred as such may exceed the value of margin collateral, in which case margin calls may be triggered. In the event that both parties agree to enter a replacement (or termination) transaction, the interest rates received (paid) under the new arrangement may differ from those in the original arrangement, even if terms other than the interest rates are identical to those in the original transaction. Risks vary by transaction. Please thoroughly read the written materials provided, such as documents delivered before making a contract and disclosure statements.

In OTC transactions of credit default swaps (CDS), no sales commission will be charged. When entering into CDS transactions, the protection buyer will be required to pledge or entrust an agreed amount of margin collateral. In some of these cases, the transaction payments may exceed the amount of margin collateral. There shall be no advance notification of required collateral value or collateral ratios as they vary depending on the financial position of the protection buyer. CDS transactions carry the risk of losses owing to changes in the credit position of some or all of the referenced entities, and/or fluctuations of the interest rate market. The amount the protection buyer receives in the event that the CDS is triggered by a credit event may undercut the total amount of premiums that he/she has paid in the course of the transaction. Similarly, the amount the protection seller pays in the event of a credit event may exceed the total amount of premiums that he/she has received in the transaction. All other conditions being equal, the amount of premiums that the protection buyer pays and that received by the protection seller shall differ. In principle, CDS transactions will be limited to financial instruments business operators and qualified institutional investors. Transfers of equities to another securities company via the Japan Securities Depository Center are subject to a transfer fee of up to ¥11,000 (tax included) per issue transferred depending on volume. No account fee will be charged for marketable securities or monies deposited.

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